

Transcriptaze[1]

THE MANUAL

You speak; the page listens.
A guardian reads along.

FOR MACOS · OCTOBER 2026

Contents

i	The Page *type, numbering, cursors*	3
ii	Voice *dictation and spoken commands*	5
iii	The Guardian *an LLM that reads along*	7
iv	The Chat *talking about the text*	10
v	Highlights *three inks, and fact-checking*	12
vi	Notes & Settings *files, export, typesetting*	14
·	Keyboard Shortcuts	15

In one minute

1. **Speak.** Press ⇧ ⌘ D and talk. Words appear at your cursor. Say “new paragraph” to start one. Press the keys again to stop.

2. **Bring a guardian.** Press ⌥ ⇧ ⌘ C to copy the connection, and give it to Claude Code, Claude Desktop or any other MCP client. It fixes misheard words and carries out what you ask for out loud.

3. **Talk it over.** Click into the chat beside the page, or press ⇧ ⌘ M. Your cursor stays behind as a ghost, so “is this right?” needs no explaining.

CHAPTER I

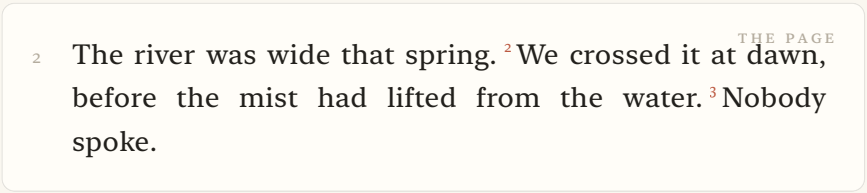
The Page

A writing surface set like a printed book, so that what you dictate already looks like prose.

Notes are set in *book* style by default: justified and hyphenated, with a first-line indent instead of a gap between paragraphs, about sixty-five characters to the line, in New York with old-style figures. The alternative, *manuscript*, is ragged-right with space between paragraphs. Choose it in Settings.

Chapter and verse

Every paragraph is numbered in the margin. From the second sentence on, every sentence gets a small raised vermilion numeral, as verses do in a printed Bible. These numbers are how you and the guardian refer to places in the text: “paragraph two, sentence three.”



The numbers are drawn on the page, not typed into it, so the file stays clean Markdown. Toggle them with ⇧ ⌘ L or the ¶ button in the format bar. The footer always shows where your cursor is, for example ¶3 · 2.

Three cursors

Three hands can write on the page. Each has its own mark.

> Yours, in ink · the guardian's, in lapis, washing what it just changed · and your ghost, left behind while you are in the chat.

The guardian's cursor is a lapis bar with a small diamond on top. When it edits, the changed words are washed in lapis for a moment, so you can see what moved without looking for it.

Wet ink

Dictated words are set a shade lighter until the guardian has read them, like ink still drying. When it has looked them over they turn to full ink. If no guardian is connected, nothing is marked.

Writing and formatting

Notes are Markdown, and the markup stays in the text but recedes into a faint grey. Use the format bar at the top of the page, the Format menu, or the keyboard:

Bold, italic, link	⌘B ⌘I ⌘K
Headings 1–3, back to body text	⌘1–3 ⌘0
Bulleted list, numbered list, quote	⇧⌘8 ⇧⌘7 ⇧⌘.
Code, strikethrough	⇧⌘C ⇧⌘X

Return continues a list; Return on an empty item ends it.

Out of the way

The format bar and footer fade while you write and return when you move the mouse. **Focus mode** (⌃⇧⌘F) hides all but the page.

CHAPTER II

Voice

Speech recognition runs on your Mac; nothing you say leaves it.

Press ⇧ ⌘ D, or click *Dictate* in the footer, to start; press it again to stop. Words land at your cursor with the spacing and capitals a typist would use, and you can click elsewhere at any time and carry on there. The first time, the button offers to fetch Kyutai's speech model from Hugging Face (2.4 GB, once); after that it loads when the app starts.

Dictation goes where you are writing

If the chat field has focus, your words go into the chat instead of the page, where the guardian reads them as they arrive. There is nothing to send. Its microphone button starts dictation there.

Two words the app catches at once

"New paragraph" and *"new line"* act the instant you say them. The words never reach the page and the cursor is already on the next line. A comma left before them becomes a full stop.

NOTE Every other command, such as "scratch that", "make this a heading" or "change flow to fleur", is carried out by the guardian. Without a guardian, those words stay on the page as text.

Voice › Dictate from Audio File… transcribes a recording the same way, in real time.

Speaking to the guardian

With a guardian connected, you can edit by voice without stopping. Say the command as part of your dictation. The guardian carries it out, then deletes the command words so they never stay in the note.

YOU SAY

"… and the light turned gold. Go to paragraph two, sentence two and change flow for fleur."

→

THE PAGE

¶2, sentence 2 now reads "fleur". The command is gone, and "and the light turned gold." stays.

THINGS YOU CAN SAY

"Scratch that."	deletes the sentence just spoken
"Make 'river' bold."	bold, italic, code, strike
"Make this a heading."	heading, quote, bullet point
"Change late to early."	replaces words, wherever they are
"Go to the end of paragraph three."	moves your cursor there
"Scroll to paragraph three."	shows it; your cursor stays put
"Guardian, is this date right?"	answered in the chat
"Read me paragraph three."	read aloud, in a natural voice

Numbers can be said as words. If a word in your command sounds like a name already in the note, the guardian uses the note's spelling. A command that trails off at the very end is left alone until you finish it.

> ◆ **How the guardian works**
>
> It reads only freshly dictated text, fixes words that were clearly misheard and the punctuation, and otherwise leaves your sentences alone. It will reword something only when you ask it to, by voice or in the chat.

CHAPTER III

The Guardian

Transcriptaze runs no language model of its own. The guardian is one you bring — ideally one that already knows your work.

The app serves the *Model Context Protocol* on your Mac, at `http://127.0.0.1:7337/mcp`. It is reachable from this computer only, never from the network. Any MCP-capable assistant can connect and become the guardian of the open note. If that assistant knows your project, your other documents or your conversation with it, it brings all of that to getting names and terms right.

Connecting

Press ⌥ ⇧ ⌘ C, or choose *Copy for LLM* in the chat's ··· menu, the guardian panel or Settings. This copies one block with the address, ready-made configuration and the working routine. Paste it to your assistant. Then, for example:

CLAUDE CODE

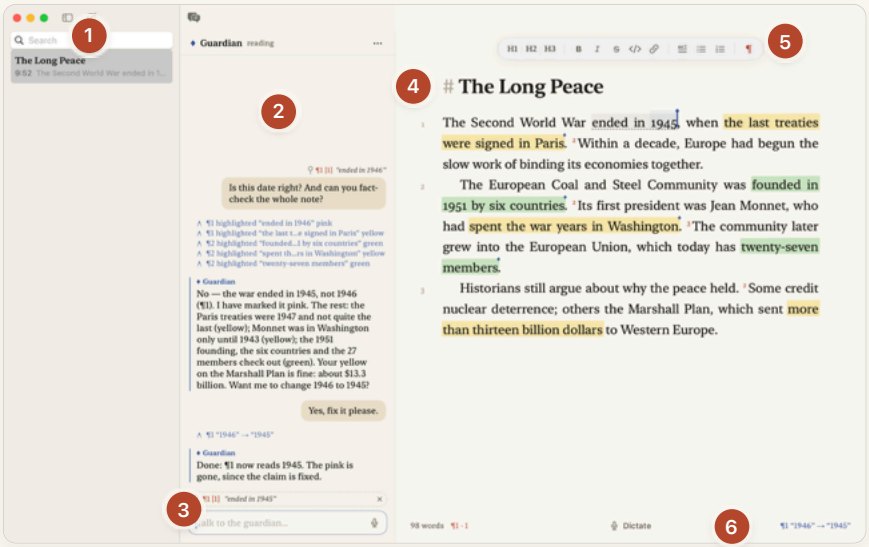
```
claude mcp add --transport http transcriptaze http://127.0.0.1:7337/mcp
```

CLAUDE DESKTOP AND OTHER STDIO CLIENTS

Use the bundled bridge, `Transcriptaze.app/Contents/MacOS/transcriptaze-mcp`, as the server command.

Then ask it to *"be the guardian of my Transcriptaze note."* The server gives it its full instructions when it connects. From then on it waits for you to speak or write, edits, and waits again.

The window



1. **Notes.** Every note in your folder, newest first, with search.
2. **The chat.** Your conversation with the guardian about this note. Its edits appear as quiet one-line notes.
3. **The pointer.** What your ghost cursor points at, shown to the guardian with your words.
4. **The page,** with paragraph numbers in the margin and highlights the guardian made while fact-checking.
5. **The format bar,** which fades while you write.
6. **The guardian's status:** what it last did. Click it for the full log and to disconnect. With the chat open, it and the Dictate button sit at the top of the chat instead.

Knowing what it is doing

The diamond in the footer is faint when no guardian is connected, steady when one is listening, and pulsing while it reads. Beside it is its last action, such as ¶1 “1946” → “1945”; click for the full log. Each edit is one undo step.

Disconnecting

Voice › Disconnect Guardian (⇧ ⌘ G) refuses its calls and tells it to stop. *Allow Guardian* lets it back in.

What the guardian can do

`read_document`	Reads the note with ¶ and sentence numbers, fresh dictation marked, your cursor and your highlights
`wait_for_dictation`	Waits until you dictate something or write in the chat
`replace_text` · `delete_text` · `insert_text` · `rewrite_sentence`	Edits, each found by paragraph number and an exact quote, so its edits stay safe while you keep talking
`split_paragraph` · `merge_paragraphs` · `insert_paragraph` · `delete_paragraph`	Paragraph structure
`format_text`	Bold, italic, headings, quotes, lists
`highlight_text` · `clear_highlights`	The three inks, with notes
`reply_in_chat` · `read_chat`	The conversation
`list_notes` · `read_note`	Your other notes, for names and context

CHAPTER IV

The Chat

A conversation with the guardian, beside the page.

Click into the chat field, or press ⇧ ⌘ M, and speak or write. There is no send button: the guardian reads along as your words arrive, and answers when you have finished a thought. Return starts a fresh message; Esc returns to the page. ⌃ ⌘ C hides or shows the chat.

The ghost cursor

In the chat, your cursor stays on the page as a *ghost*: a thin bar with a ring, or a dotted underline under a selection. A chip above the field shows what it points at, and every message carries it, so *"is this right?"* needs no explaining.

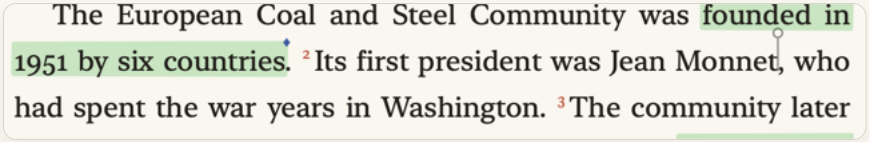


FIG. 1 *The ghost after "Monnet", left there while you write in the chat.*

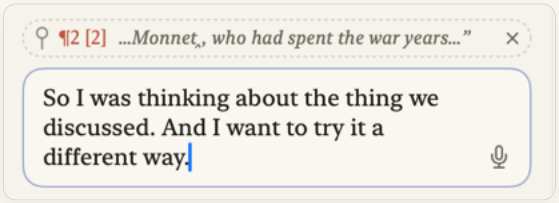


FIG. 2 *The pointer chip, ¶2 [2], and a message dictated into the chat. The × stops pointing anywhere.*

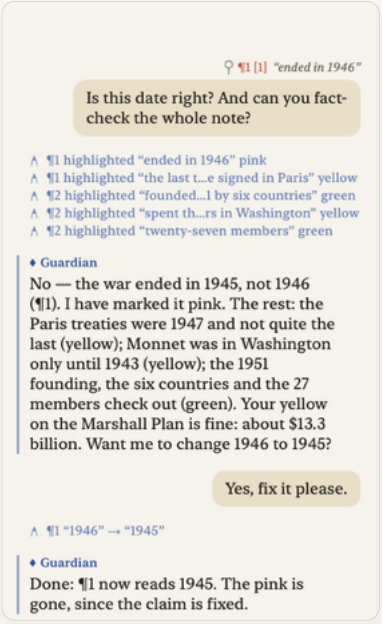


FIG. 3 *A fact-check, start to finish.*

Reading the conversation

Your messages sit on the right, in a soft bubble, with what you were pointing at above them in small type. The guardian's replies sit on the left behind a lapis rule.

Between them, in small lapis lines, are the edits it made, so you can read each reply against what it actually did.

Under what you are saying you see whether the guardian has it: *reads along*, then *Read*, with three dots while it works. Its answer closes your words into a message of their own.

Asking for changes

In the chat the guardian may do more than fix mishearings. Ask it to reword a sentence, tighten a paragraph or move something, and it does, then tells you what it did. Ask before it acts: "what would you cut here?"

By voice alone

You never need the keyboard. While dictating on the page, begin with *"Guardian, …"* and ask. The guardian lifts your words off the page into the chat, marked said on the page, and answers there. Or click into the chat and just talk.

CHAPTER V

Highlights

Three inks — yellow, green and pink — for marking text. You and the guardian both use them.

Making one

Select some text. Three swatches rise in the margin beside it; click one. If the window is narrow, they sit just above the selection instead.

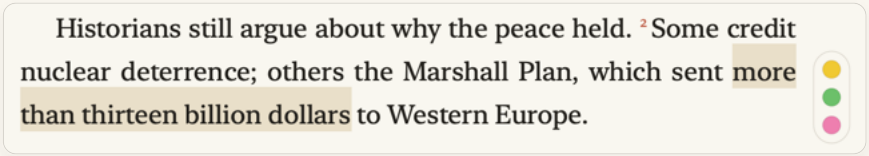


FIG. 4 *The swatches beside a selection. A fourth, hollow swatch appears when the selection already holds highlights; it removes them.*

From the keyboard: ⌥ ⌘ 1 yellow, ⌥ ⌘ 2 green, ⌥ ⌘ 3 pink, and ⌥ ⌘ 0 to remove highlights from the selection. These are in the Format menu too.

Letting one go

Click it and it fades away. Or simply **edit inside it**: changing highlighted words dismisses the highlight, because what it marked is no longer there. Typing just after it leaves it alone. Clicked one away by mistake? ⌘ Z brings it back.

What the inks mean

The colours mean whatever you agree with the guardian. Unless you say otherwise, it uses them for fact-checking:

Green	confirmed — checked, and true
Yellow	partly true, uncertain, or worth a second look
Pink	false, or a problem

The guardian's highlights carry a tiny lapis diamond at their end. Hold the mouse over any highlight to read the guardian's note: the correct fact, or why it is unsure.

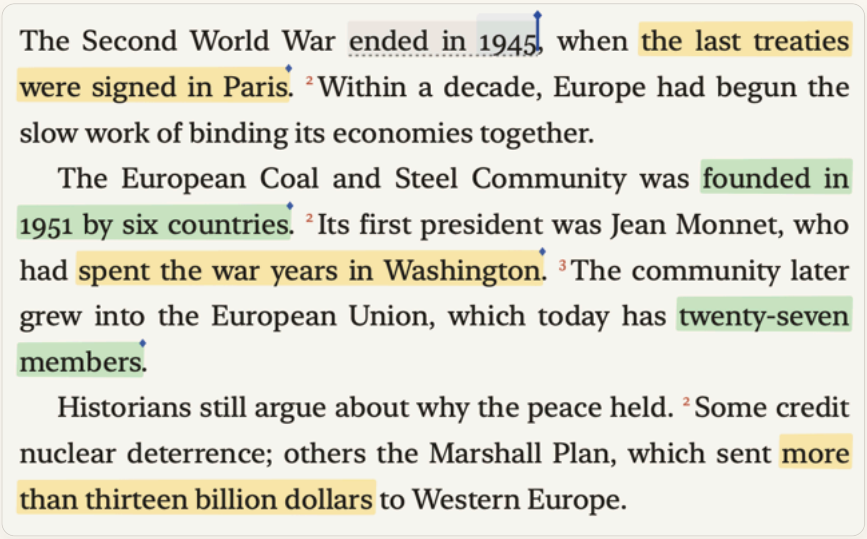


FIG. 5 *After "fact-check the whole note". The false date was pink until the guardian corrected it, which dismissed the highlight.*

A FACT-CHECKING ROUTINE

1. Ask in the chat: *"Fact-check this note."*
2. Read the pinks and yellows; hover for the notes.
3. Say *"fix the pinks"*, or correct them yourself. Each fix clears its highlight.
4. Click away any highlight you are done with.

CHAPTER VI

Notes & Settings

Plain files

Every note is an ordinary Markdown file in `~/Documents/Transcriptaze`, saved as you write. The file is named after the note's first line, and renamed when the first line changes. Any other app, and any guardian, can read it.

Highlights and the chat are not written into your Markdown. They live in a small companion file in a hidden `.transcriptaze` folder beside your notes, and follow the note when it is renamed.

THE SIDEBAR

⌘ N starts a new note. Search filters by title and text. Right-click a note to show it in Finder or move it to the Trash.

EXPORT

File › Export as Markdown… (⇧ ⌘ E) or *Export as Plain Text…*, which strips the markup.

Settings ⌘,

Page	Book or Manuscript
Typeface	New York, Iowan Old Style, Charter, Avenir Next
Size · leading · measure	14–28 pt · 1.2–2.0 · 480–900 pt
Chapter-and-verse numbering	on or off
Guardian	server address, setup to copy

Keyboard Shortcuts

VOICE & GUARDIAN

Dictation on / off	⇧ ⌘ D
Go to the chat	⇧ ⌘ M
Back to the page	Esc
Disconnect / allow	⇧ ⌘ G
Read aloud · stop	⌥ ⌘ R ⌘ .
Copy connection	⌥ ⇧ ⌘ C

HIGHLIGHTS

🟡 Yellow	⌥ ⌘ 1
🟢 Green	⌥ ⌘ 2
🩷 Pink	⌥ ⌘ 3
Remove	⌥ ⌘ 0

VIEW

Show / hide chat	⌃ ⌘ C
Focus mode	⌃ ⇧ ⌘ F
Numbering	⇧ ⌘ L

NOTES

New note	⌘ N
Export as Markdown	⇧ ⌘ E
Settings	⌘ ,

FORMAT

Bold · italic	⌘ B ⌘ I
Link	⌘ K
Heading 1–3	⌘ 1 – 3
Body text	⌘ 0
Bulleted list	⇧ ⌘ 8
Numbered list	⇧ ⌘ 7
Quote	⇧ ⌘ .
Code	⇧ ⌘ C
Strikethrough	⇧ ⌘ X

HELP

This manual	⌘ ?



Set in New York, the typeface
the app sets your notes in.

Transcription by Kyutai, *stt-1b-en_fr*,
running on your Mac. Weights licensed CC-BY 4.0.

The guardian is yours to choose.